

faces challenges from stringent regulations and an uneven playing field. Ivy Chin from the investment platform Inflection Point Ventures highlights that India is a robust destination for tech investments, but it needs to strengthen its data laws. To foster innovation, the government must create an environment conducive to competition and collaboration, streamlining bureaucratic processes, and ensuring fair market access. She claims that introducing tax incentives and grants to support research and development will bolster India's tech ecosystem.

"With an evolving environment, seamless cross-border technology sharing and adoption, India has some focus areas to work on. These would be strengthening data protection laws to instill confidence among

users and businesses, clearly defining rules for data collection, storage, and usage to protect user privacy and building trust in the digital ecosystem," says Chin.

Chin believes that making licensing procedures clear and transparent, and avoiding ambiguity will help boost growth of tech start-ups. Policies that specifically support the growth of small and medium-sized tech enterprises should be promoted. This could include financial incentives, mentorship programmes, and easier access to funding.

BRIDGING THE DIGITAL DIVIDE

Despite advancements, a significant portion of India's population remains digitally disenfranchised. Chin points towards internet penetration disparities among states,

along with literacy rates and income. To bridge this gap, India needs strategies that address both access and utilisation of technology. For Chin, the solution could be policies that extend beyond connectivity to improve livelihoods, such as local economy development, digital skill training, and entrepreneurship programmes. Adapting educational curricula to include practical, tech-focussed skills is also crucial in preparing for a digital future.

"Disparities are evident in internet penetration between states. Goa, Maharashtra, and Kerala boast higher rates, while Jharkhand, Bihar, and Uttar Pradesh lag behind. A correlation with literacy rates and per capita income suggests these factors contribute to the divide. For instance, the three states with lower internet penetration also have literacy rates below 66%, and their per capita income is less than 80,000," says Chin.

TACKLING ONLINE SOCIAL ISSUES

The proliferation of social media and online platforms has escalated issues like cyber bullying, hate speech, and misinformation. The rapid advances in technologies have made it very difficult to protect users from online harm. Deepfakes, for instance, are very difficult to even identify without the use of state-of-the-art technology and it is often the case that the 'intermediary' platform being used as a mode of disseminating such misinformation ends up taking the brunt of bad press.

INDUSLAW's Suri points out how complex a problem it is to protect users from online harm. She claims platforms often bear the brunt of disseminating misinformation. Hence, there's a need for robust mechanisms to report and

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"The DPDPA is fairly robust and the penalties contemplated for different kinds of violations act as much as a deterring factor as any for data fiduciaries"

SHREYA SURI
PARTNER AT INDUSLAW



"Over 90% of deepfakes are related to adult content, causing reputational damage and misinformation. So, we need guidelines to tackle this"

AGAM CHOUDHARY
CEO, TWO99